SIGNS OF A STRESSED EMPLOYEE

Social withdrawal

Neglecting responsibilities

Decreased productivity

Absenteeism, erratic work patterns

Negative thinking, feeling overwhelmed

fer them counselling to cope. Instead, they must determine how job roles and resources are allocated, since that determines employee workload and, in turn, their working hours. "Long working hours essentially mean the company isn't investing enough in human capital, and there aren't enough people to share the workload," says Pallavi Jha of Dale Carnegie Training India. She shares how when they wanted the sales team to focus more on growth and revenue generation, they created a new role: sales support. The new team began handling operational tasks, freeing up the sales team's time. Training managers, too, is key, as they shape the culture of their teams. Supratik Bhattacharyya, chief talent officer at the RPG Group, shares how their CXOs undergo a sensitisation session with the president of HR and the rest with the CHRO.

Not tending to employee well-being entails a cost, as a 2022 survey by Deloitte, 'Mental health and well-being in the workplace', showed. Indian employers, it estimated, lose around $14 billion (Rs 1.18 lakh crore) annually thanks to absenteeism, lower productivity and attrition. For a country aiming to be the world's third-largest economy, it is something India can ill afford. ■

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